Executive Summary: A National Strategy to Strengthen Canada Through Tourism

Fueling Canada's Future – Economic Strength Through Purpose-Driven Tourism

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Canada stands at a pivotal moment to transform tourism into one of its most strategic national tools. Amid global shifts in travel preferences, environmental awareness, and geopolitical optics, Canada offers a compelling alternative: safe, welcoming, nature-rich, and culturally vibrant experiences that reflect the country's values of sustainability, inclusivity, and reconciliation.

This proposal outlines how tourism can serve as a powerful lever for national benefit — stimulating foreign revenue, fostering small business ecosystems, encouraging interprovincial mobility, and reinforcing Canadian identity. Unlike traditional tourism focused merely on sightseeing, this strategy envisions purpose-driven journeys that connect people across landscapes, seasons, and cultural traditions.

It proposes a framework organized around population interests: nature exploration, Indigenous culture, urban life, outdoor sports, professional and lifestyle experiences, industrial education, and culinary celebration. These journeys span from coast to coast and across the full calendar year — creating opportunities in every province and in every season.

To activate this, we recommend:

- A narrative theme (e.g. "Not Just for Pictures" or "From Coast to Heart") to unify the national experience
- Clear segmentation of tourism offerings and corresponding journey maps
- Infrastructure investment in transportation, local guides, and regional accommodations
- Incentives for community-based tourism businesses and events
- Policies for controlled access to preserve community integrity and environmental quality

The proposal anticipates challenges — such as overcrowding, rule violations, or waste — and provides mitigation strategies including exclusivity caps, stronger law enforcement, and dedicated cleanup investment.

The broader impacts are far-reaching: global visibility for Canadian culture and Indigenous nations, attraction of high-caliber immigrants and international talent, and positioning Canada as a global benchmark for ethical and sustainable tourism.

Tourism is no longer just an economic category. It is a medium through which Canada can express its soul — to its people and to the world. With careful stewardship and bold vision, this strategy invites policymakers to unlock a generational opportunity that benefits both local communities and Canada's global standing.